

the answer to that second question is yes. Your goal is to avoid a divorce at all costs, because the minute you involve a lawyer, you'll start to bleed assets, not to mention rip your family apart. Bring in a therapist or a mediator if that's what it takes. This can be costly, but it's still a lot cheaper than divorce. Ladies, here's your chance to enact your personalized Denise Decree. Gentlemen, here's your chance not to screw it up.

A DECADE-BY-DECADE GUIDE TO MANAGING YOUR ASSETS

Below, you will find a decade-by-decade guide to managing your assets. If you follow the advice here, you'll earn yourself some financial peace and security later on and you'll also ensure that your family dynasty stays safe, even in the moments when you're tempted to throw it all away.

THE 30s

During your thirties, you should be entirely focused on *paying off debt*. Work like mad, even if it means making sacrifices, like not buying the boat you've been salivating over or not going on that fancy vacation. If you're like most people, you're still paying off your student loans in your 30s, so do that and don't make the mistake of getting a new debt to replace your old one. After the 30s, no more debt. That's your goal.

THE 40s

If you haven't paid off all your creditors, it's time to get serious. The year I turned 40, I decided I had to pay off everything, fast. Between the ages 35 and 42, I worked insane hours seven days a week toward that goal. By 42, I had no mortgage and no